

Work-Family Strategies During COVID-19: Examining Gender Dynamics Among Dual-Earner Couples With Young Children

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There are several existing typologies of dual-earner couples focused on how they dually manage work and family; however, these all assume that couples can outsource childcare during normal work hours and that work is largely conducted outside of the home. Early attempts to control COVID-19 altered these assumptions with daycares/schools closing and the heavy shift to remote work. This calls into question whether couples tended to fall back on familiar gendered patterns to manage work and family, or if they adopted new strategies for the unique pandemic situation. We addressed this question using a sample of 274 dual-earner couples with young children. We content coded couples' qualitative responses about their plans for managing childcare and work commitments and used these codes in a latent class analysis to identify subgroups. Seven classes were identified, with 36.6% of the sample using strategies where women did most or all childcare, 18.9% of the sample using strategies that were not clearly gendered or egalitarian, and 44.5% of the sample using unique egalitarian strategies. We also obtained data from 133 of these couples approximately 7 weeks later regarding their well-being and job performance. Results suggested that women in the *Remote Wife Does It All* class had the lowest well-being and performance. There were nuanced differences between the egalitarian strategies in their relationships with outcomes, with the *Alternating Days* egalitarian category emerging as the overall strategy that best preserved wives' and husbands' well-being while allowing both to maintain adequate job performance.

Keywords: work-family, dual-earner couples, division of childcare, gender, remote work

Researchers have noted several typologies of broad strategies that dual-earner couples use to generally manage work and family (e.g., Hall & MacDermid, 2009; Masterson & Hoobler, 2015; Sweet & Moen, 2006). There are nuanced differences across these typologies, but a common trend is that the most prevalent strategies involve some form of a “neo-traditional” division of labor, where women are primary caretakers inside the home and take on disproportionately more childcare and men work primarily outside the home and their careers are prioritized. This research also assumes that dual-earner couples have the option to outsource childcare during normal work hours and that work is largely conducted outside of the home.

The early stages of the COVID-19 pandemic in the United States introduced an unprecedented context that altered these assumptions. Specifically, institutional and governmental reactions to control the pandemic included the closing of most childcare centers and in-person schools. This sudden substantial increase in childcare responsibilities for dual-earner couples was not necessarily balanced by a reduction in work responsibilities; couples were together confronted with the immediate and ongoing need to *simultaneously* fulfill both work and childcare roles. That is, the division of childcare labor was no longer confined to hours outside of the typical workday, and the boundaries between work and home became blurred for many. Additionally, with the heavy shift to remote work (Hickman & Saad, 2020), men were much more physically present in the home than ever before. Physical proximity, and the associated increased salience of family demands, had the potential to markedly shift traditional gendered patterns of behavior.

Despite anecdotal discussion of gendered strategies in the popular press (e.g., Charlton, 2020; Cohen & Hsu, 2020; Smith, 2020), there are no known empirical tests of what strategies couples are actually using to manage childcare during COVID-19. As such, we do not have knowledge of whether these strategies are highly gendered (as tended to be the case pre-COVID-19) or if new, more egalitarian strategies are being adopted in light of the unique context. Based on these ideas, the goal of the present study was to address the question of whether, in the COVID-19 context, couples are creating novel work-family (WF) management strategies that transcend gender roles or if they are falling back on the familiar

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patterns seen in previous research during “typical” times. Importantly, we further examined the relationship of these strategies with men and women’s job performance and well-being (including health and family functioning). We addressed these questions in a sample of dual-earner heterosexual couples with young children (under age 6) who had stable childcare arrangements pre-COVID-19 but whose childcare arrangements were subsequently disrupted. We surveyed them the week that childcare arrangements were largely suspended across the United States and 6.5–8.5 weeks later to assess outcomes.

Our research makes several important contributions to the literature. First, in providing basic information about couples’ WF management strategies during the pandemic and how these strategies link to key outcomes, we hope to answer calls to examine WF situations in times of crisis (Eby et al., 2015) and to contribute to the literature about best practices during such times. The COVID-19 pandemic can be considered a crisis situation, defined as a “low-probability, high impact event” that is characterized by ambiguity, uncertainty regarding means of resolution, and significant consequences (Yu et al., 2008). Given the crisis context, one cannot assume prior typologies of couples’ WF management strategies would mirror current findings. Crisis situations may have discontinuous effects on individuals and couples (Eby et al., 2015) and reveal new, complex associations between division of labor and outcomes. If we find that certain strategies are better in this crisis situation than others for well-being and performance, couples may gain insight into how they may adjust their own strategies moving forward during the pandemic, in other crisis situations in the future (e.g., natural disasters), or even in more minor situations once COVID-19 has subsided (e.g., child is sick for a few days and must stay home).

Second, our study empirically answers anecdotal questions about gender and childcare during the pandemic. By examining the gender dynamics within couples’ WF management strategies, we provide important evidence that has implications for understanding (a) potential downstream career consequences for men and women and (b) the extent to which the gendered separate spheres of work and home are fixed versus adaptive to crisis. With regard to the former point, if women take on the bulk of childcare duties during the pandemic, this could be a leading indicator of backtracking in women’s progression in organizations. With regard to the latter point, understanding what happens when work and home are in the same sphere for both men and women offers a unique lens into the malleability of the gendered division of household labor.

A third contribution of our study is linking dual-earner WF management strategies to well-being and performance outcomes. There is a surprising dearth of research on this topic generally. Although we focus on short-term implications in the context of a pandemic, our findings may be able to guide research outside the pandemic as well (e.g., short-term relationship tension stemming from a particular WF management strategy may manifest in more stable attitudes such as marital dissatisfaction if that strategy is adopted long-term). Furthermore, short-term implications are important in their own right as they can have meaningful downstream effects on individual well-being (e.g., lack of sleep has been linked to obesity, hypertension, and diabetes; Altman et al., 2012), relationship outcomes (e.g., tension from this situation may simmer and resentment may build between spouses), and workplace out-

comes (e.g., companies may use the current situation to make long-term decisions such as promotions or raises).

Dual-Earner Couples’ Work-Family Management Strategies

There are numerous extant typologies of dual-earner couples in the literature and they vary in the focal variable used to categorize couples, including work and family salience (Yogev & Brett, 1985), family identity (Masterson & Hoobler, 2015), career decisions (Becker & Moen, 1999; Pixley, 2008), hours in childcare, household labor, and/or paid employment of each spouse (Hall & MacDermid, 2009; Kitterød & Lappegård, 2012; Sweet & Moen, 2006). Common themes across typologies include some version of the following: (a) both people are highly committed to work and to family demands, and may rely on specific strategies such as outsourcing, reducing performance standards, or reducing sleep time, (b) asymmetrical strategies that involve one person devoting more to work (family) while the other devotes more time to the other domain, (c) and one person taking on the bulk of family labor while not scaling back at work. The latter two strategies are highly gendered—it is usually the wife who scales back work or takes on a “second shift”—and they represent a large proportion of couples in most studies.

Turning to the COVID-19 context, we draw from multiple theoretical lenses to inform why potential WF management strategies may be highly gendered as found in previous work, or may depart from this pattern. Numerous theories have been put forth to explain the gendered division of labor (cf. Shockley & Shen, 2016); we hone in on theories that focus on gender itself rather than factors that correlate with gender (e.g., relative resources, economic theories of specialization). The “doing gender” (West & Zimmerman, 1987, 2009) perspective argues that due to gender role socialization women (men) view domestic (paid) labor as an act that affirms femininity (masculinity), which contributes to the asymmetrical patterns. Similarly, Blair-Loy (2003) asserts couples rarely question the idea that the wife rather than the husband should cut back on work to care for children because of internalized cultural schemas of women’s family devotion (Eagly, 1987; Haines et al., 2016). Additionally, marital power theories (Rollins & Bahr, 1976) argue that the person with more power in a marriage prevails in situations of conflicting goals (e.g., who will sacrifice work when childcare is necessary). Holding other factors (e.g., relative resources) constant, gender (being male) is a predictor of power in part due to hegemonic masculinity embedded in society (e.g., Lukes, 2005; Messerschmidt, 2018). There is little reason to suspect that COVID-19 would fundamentally alter any of these aforementioned processes, suggesting that WF management strategies during COVID-19 mimic the gendered strategies commonly used before the pandemic. Indeed, a rare study of WF strategies during a crisis (Sigurdardottir & Garðarsdóttir, 2018) suggests a gendered trend. Researchers found that Icelandic men took shorter parental leave after the 2008 economic recession compared to the preceding 4 years, although the opposite trend was observed for women, who took longer leaves.

On the other hand, characteristics unique to COVID-19 invoke other theoretical concepts that introduce the potential for new strategies. The notion that men and women can and should be relegated to (or maintain primary responsibility for) work and

home roles, respectively, is deeply ingrained in social norms around the globe (e.g., the concept of “separate spheres”; Davis & Greenstein, 2009; Kerber, 1988). Yet the situational demands imposed by the pandemic have the potential to disrupt those norms for a variety of reasons. First, the restriction of movement imposed by the pandemic meant that work and home were no longer separate spaces; the sharp increase in remote work resulted in a sharp decrease in the physical boundaries between work and home. This meant that many men no longer had the option of leaving home for work and were thus physically embedded with their families. Meal preparation and emotional and physical needs of children may have been more immediately salient for men than ever before.

Second, the pandemic confronted couples with a necessary and urgent decision-making context often involving substantial changes to *both* members’ work arrangements. This context is meaningfully different from previously studied decisions, such as whether one partner should take a new job or which partner is responsible for picking up a sick child, because it explicitly involves *both* partners’ work *and* home lives. The possibility that work and home could be separate spheres for men and women may have been completely disrupted by the pandemic and thus allow for noticeable change.

Third, the double ABCX model of family stress and adaptation (Hill, 1958; McCubbin & Patterson, 1983) explicitly focuses on how families adapt to crisis situations. The model is complex, but a core idea is that the successful coping of families to crisis situations depends in part on their ability to accept shifting role patterns and expectations (Hill, 1958). A key takeaway relevant to the present context is that many couples do substantially shift their roles in reaction to crisis situations rather than rely on previous defaults.

Based on these varying perspectives, we pose the following as a research question:

Research Question 1: In the COVID-19 context, are couples using unique, new WF management strategies or are they falling back on the familiar gendered patterns found in previous research?

Outcomes of Couples’ Work-Family Management Strategies

As noted above, there is very little research linking general couple-level WF management strategies to well-being or job performance outcomes. However, some evidence can be gleaned from the related general division of labor literature. Research on uneven division of family labor is quite mixed in terms of marital quality and the relationship seems to be moderated by perceptions of fairness, such that marital quality decreases for the person doing more labor if he or she feels it is unfair (cf. Shockley & Shen, 2016). In terms of health outcomes, psychological distress has received the most attention, with the bulk of studies finding that couples who divide paid and family labor in an egalitarian manner experience the lowest distress. Lastly, there is some evidence when women’s careers are prioritized or they earn more than men (e.g., a “non-traditional” division of paid labor) both men and women have poorer health outcomes (cf. Shockley & Shen, 2016). In summary, the trend seems to be that more egalitarian strategies

lead to most favorable outcomes at least for health and marital outcomes, although there are some nuances to these findings based on the nature of the nonegalitarian strategy and gender.

In the present context, we decided to focus on well-being in the family, health, and job performance domains for a holistic assessment. Rather than focusing on more enduring attitudes such as marital satisfaction, we examined marital relationship tension which may vary more on a short-term basis (Birditt et al., 2017). We also examined family cohesion, with the idea that strategies chosen during COVID-19 could impact the family as a whole rather than just the couple. In terms of health, we focused on psychological distress given the precedent in the literature, as well as sleep hours. We thought sleep hours were particularly important during the pandemic because of the time crunch with added childcare, resulting in potential cuts to sleep. Finally, in order to see the job-related implications, we used two indicators of self-reported job performance (general job performance and job performance relative to pre-COVID-19) over the study period. For each outcome, we examined the wives’ and husbands’ reports separately. For variables that were individual in nature (performance and health variables) we also calculated a summed variable to represent well-being and performance across the couple.

Research Question 2: To what extent do the respective WF strategies relate to wives’ and husbands’ family functioning (relationship tension, family cohesion), health (sleep hours and psychological distress), and job performance?

Method

Participants

Participants were 334 married couples living in the United States (668 individuals). In order to be eligible, couples had to meet the following criteria at the Time 1 survey: Both spouses worked full-time (>32 hr per week) and were still required to work (whether remote or not) during sheltering in place orders. The couple had to have at least one child under age 6 with regular daytime childcare unavailable (e.g., daycare was closed, nanny could not come). We further screened out 35 couples because we suspected that their responses were from a single person rather than an actual couple¹, and 16 additional couples because their responses to the open-ended questions revealed they did not meet the study criteria (i.e., unmarried or not working, $n = 3$), or their open-ended responses were too terse or indecipherable ($n = 13$). Lastly, we removed 9 couples in same sex marriages.² Therefore, we had usable data from 274 couples at Time 1.

The Time 1 survey was administered March 18–23, 2020. This was immediately following the closings of most schools and daycare facilities across the United States, and the declaration of a

¹ Couples were removed if both individuals were using the same email address, their IP address and names were linked to multiple couples, or if individuals were responding to emails and surveys directed towards their spouse.

² We removed same sex couples because our theoretical perspectives were largely focused on different gender roles within a couple, for which we used sex as a proxy. We believe issues of childcare during COVID-19 are equally relevant to same sex couples, but it did not fit into the particular framework of this study.

national health emergency on March 13. Couples were recruited via snowball methodology through posting on the researchers' social networks and personal contacts ($n = 51$) and through paid Facebook ads ($n = 232$). The "first" spouse completed the survey first, provided his or her spouse's email address and then the "second" spouse was contacted about completing his or her survey. The surveys were identical, except that eligibility questions and couple-level demographic questions were only asked of the first spouse. Couples were compensated \$7 per person in Amazon gift cards, or with a \$2 donation to the World Health Organization (WHO).

Time 2 surveys were administered May 7–18, 2020. At this point in time, many states had only just begun their initial phases of reopening (Lee et al., 2020) and schools and the majority of childcare facilities remained closed (Guynn, 2020). This gave participants a substantial period (6.5–8.5 weeks) during which they dealt with sheltering in place regulations and daycare and school closures. A total of 188 couples completed the Time 2 survey. The Time 2 sample size was further reduced to 179 couples after screening out those who failed more than one attention check (described below) at either Time 1 or Time 2. The spouses received identical surveys and each person was compensated \$5 in Amazon gift cards or a \$1 WHO donation. Demographics and analysis for nonresponse bias are listed in Table 1. This study was approved by the University of Georgia's Institutional Review Board ("Work and Family Struggles during the COVID-19 Outbreak"; Project #00002089).

Measures

All items are listed in the Appendix. All items were completed by both spouses. For Time 2 measures participants were asked to reflect on the period since they took the first survey.

Plan for Managing Childcare and Work Commitments (Time 1)

Participants responded to three open-ended questions created for the study to assess the couple's plan for dealing with work and

childcare: (a) "What is you and your spouse's plan for dealing with both of your work commitments during the upcoming period when your normal childcare is disrupted? Please be as detailed as possible." (b) "How will you have to adjust your work role during this time?" and (c) "How will your spouse have to adjust his/her work role during this time?"

Implementation of Plan (Time 2)

Participants were first reminded of their verbatim response from Time 1 regarding their intended plan. They were then asked to rate how well they followed that plan. Responses were set on a 10-point Likert scale ranging from *did not follow the plan at all* to *followed the plan perfectly*.

Family Functioning (Time 2)

Family cohesion was assessed using Huffman et al.'s (2017) 3-item measure and *marital relationship tension* was assessed using three items from Matthews et al.'s (2006). Responses were set on a 5-point *strongly disagree* to *strongly agree* Likert scale.

Health

Sleep quantity was assessed by asking "During this time period, on average, how many hours of actual sleep did you get at night?" *Psychological distress* was assessed with Kessler et al.'s (2002) 10-item measure. Responses were set on a 5-point Likert scale ranging from *none of the time* to *all of the time*.

Job Performance

Self-rated job performance was assessed in two ways. First, participants completed a four-item measure from Abramis (1994). Responses were set on a 5-point Likert scale ranging from *very poorly* to *exceptionally well*. Second, we assessed the extent to which participants felt they had met their work responsibilities during this period using a study-created item: "During the pandemic many parents have not been able to meet 100% of their work responsibilities. What percentage of your work responsibilities

Table 1
Sample Demographics

Variables	Time 1 ($N = 274$)			Time 2 ($N = 133$)			Comparison between Time 1 and Time 2 (t , χ^2 for race/ethnicity)
	Dyad-level	Wives	Husbands	Dyad-level	Wives	Husbands	
Household income (USD)	140,702.70 (72,147.89)			139,402.60 (81,745.43)			.16
Number of children <6	1.36 (.56)			1.34 (.54)			.34
Number of children <18	1.84 (.82)			1.74 (.75)			1.18
Weekly work hours		41.27 (5.66)	44.17 (7.88)		40.68 (4.70)	44.02 (8.29)	1.04, .17
Age ^a		34.81 (5.78)	36.33 (6.60)		35.17 (6.37)	36.34 (6.96)	.54, .01
Race/Ethnicity ^a (%)							3.4, 1.15
White		78.6	76.7		78.7	78.2	
Hispanic/Latino		6.2	7.6		7.4	7.3	
Black/African American		5.8	6.1		4.1	6.4	
Asian		6.6	7.1		9.0	7.3	
American Indian/Alaskan Native		1.2	.5		.8	0	
Other		1.6	1.8		0	.9	

Note. Values are M and (SD) unless otherwise noted.

^a Due to an error in survey administration, race/ethnicity and age were only collected for a subset of the data ($N = 243$ for wives and 197 for husbands for Time 1 and $N = 122$ and 110 for Time 2). None of the t -tests or chi-squares were significant, indicating no significant differences between the Time 1 and Time 2 samples.

ities do you feel that you met during this time?” Individuals responded using a slider scale ranging from 0% to 100%.

Attention Checks

Five items were used to measure careless responding and were presented randomly throughout the surveys (e.g., “I do not understand a word of English”). Responses were set on a 5-point Likert scale that ranged from *strongly disagree* to *strongly agree*. Responses were deemed incorrect if they did not select one of two response options reflecting the correct level of agreement (e.g., *strongly disagree* or *disagree* in the example).

Scores across the couple (health, psychological distress, general and relative job performance) were computed by summing the individual scores.

Results

Coding of Stated Plans

We followed an inductive process in generating codes for the descriptions of plans for managing childcare and work commitments. We reviewed the wife’s and husband’s reports in tandem to provide a holistic assessment of the plans. Two of the study authors each reviewed a unique subset of the data (20% each) and independently generated common categories that emerged from the descriptions as well as different codes within each category. These categories were compared and refined. Next, all four of the study authors reviewed a separate randomly selected subset of the data (10%) and attempted to code using the initial code sheet. It was agreed upon that substantial refinements to the coding sheet were necessary. The coders met to discuss these refinements and then formally coded the subset. Agreement was 89.3%. All instances where coders were not in perfect agreement were discussed and further minor clarifications and revisions were made to the coding sheet. We then moved forward in having two coders per description. Agreement across cases and categories was 74.8%. In all cases where there was a coding disagreement a third coder was assigned. In 89.5% of these cases, the new coder chose one of the existing codes and we selected the majority code. In the remaining 10.5%, a fourth coder reviewed the codes and a majority code emerged.

Analyses

We address Research Question 1 in two ways. First, in Table 2, we present the distinct categories that emerged from the data and the prevalence of various alternatives within each category. Next, in order to determine if certain patterns across categories emerged within the data we conducted a latent class analysis (LCA), a technique which identifies latent subgroups based on individual responses from multivariate categorical data (Rindskopf, 2009).³ We conducted the LCA using Mplus 7.4 (Muthén & Muthén, 2015) and began by specifying one profile and increased the number of profiles until fit no longer substantially improved. Following best practice recommendations (e.g., Gabriel et al., 2018), we determined fit by looking for lower values with the Akaike information criterion (AIC), Bayesian information criterion (BIC), consistent AIC (C-AIC) and sample-size-adjusted BIC, higher values for entropy, and significant values for the Lo-

Mendell-Rubin likelihood ratio test and the bootstrap likelihood ratio test. The results of the LCA are shown in Table 3. As there are no clear criteria for LCA fit indices, we looked at the various indicators holistically, prioritizing those in which the BIC and C-AIC values were lowest, to determine the best factor solution (e.g., Peugh & Fan, 2013). The 7-factor solution has the lowest BIC, C-AIC, and AIC; thus, we proceeded with 7 factors.

Table 4 shows the descriptive labels given to each class, representative quotes, and the proportion of couples in that class that were assigned a particular code for each category. This gives a sense of what the modal strategies across categories were for each of the seven classes.

With regard to Research Question 1, several of the strategies reflected gendered patterns. Specifically, two of the strategies—*Wife Remote and Does it All* and *Wife Remote and Husband Pitches in on Occasion* (“*Wife Remote Doing Most*”)—were clearly gendered and included 31.8% of the sample. The *Husband Not Remote and Outsourcing Fully or Partially Outsourcing With Wife Filling in Gap* also had a gendered component for 36% of the couples in this class, or 4.8% of the total sample. Thus, 36.6% of the total sample used traditional gendered strategies.

Other categories emerged that have been noted in some previous work as couple WF management strategies, albeit less common ones, include *Wife Not Remote and Staggering Shiftwork or Husband Does Childcare* (10.4%). *Outsourcing Fully* (64% of 13.3% = 8.5%) has been mentioned in some conceptual work (Masterson & Hoobler, 2015), but it seems fairly unique during COVID-19 given the higher reliance on friends or family than formal paid childcare.

Three unique egalitarian categories emerged—*Alternating Working Days While Not Remote and Reducing Hours* (“*Alternating Days*”), *Egalitarian Remote Workers With Planned Minishifts* (“*Remote Mini-shifts*”), *Egalitarian Remote Workers With Daily Need-based Alternation Without Reducing Work Hours* (“*Remote Need-Based Alternating*”). Together, these comprised 44.5% of the sample. Thus, in response to Research Question 1 there was a mix of unique and “typical” strategies.

To address Research Question 2, we examined mean differences in the outcome variables by using the LCA automatic 3-step approach for auxiliary variables (Asparouhov & Muthén, 2014) where the outcome variables are examined in relation to class membership probabilities, taking into account the error in class prediction (Wang & Hanges, 2011). Before running these analyses, we trimmed the data to only those who completed the Time 2 survey ($n = 172$). We also examined how well people followed through with their plan and eliminated those who reported they had followed through less than 6 on the 10-point scale ($n = 39$). We

³ LCA will only allow a maximum number of 10 options per category, which was problematic with the Division of Childcare Labor During Normal Work Hours category where there were 11. To remedy this, we removed the category with the smallest n for men (“Doing all childcare when not outsourced”) and women (“Doing none of the childcare when not outsourced”; $n = 3$ couples), reasoning that the n was likely too small to create meaningful classes. These data were coded as missing on that category.

Table 2
Content Coding Frequencies

Category	Frequency (%)
Remote Work Status	
Wives	
Working remote full time	180 (65.7%)
Not working remote	59 (21.5%)
Working remote partially (stable schedule)	9 (3.3%)
Alternating working remote with spouse	7 (2.6%)
Occasionally working remote (one day here and there)	7 (2.6%)
Could not decipher from response	12 (4.4%)
Husbands	
Not working remote	122 (44.5%)
Working remote full time	116 (42.3%)
Occasionally working remote (one day here and there)	9 (3.3%)
Working remote partially (stable schedule)	8 (2.9%)
Alternating working remote with spouse	7 (2.6%)
Could not decipher from response	12 (4.4%)
Outside Help	
No outside help	191 (69.7%)
Relative, friend, or older sibling helping part-time	42 (15.3%)
Relative, friend, or older sibling helping full-time	14 (5.1%)
Not officially part of the current plan, but considering finding outside help as an option in the future	9 (3.3%)
Paid help (e.g., nanny or babysitter) part-time	6 (2.2%)
Paid help (e.g., nanny or babysitter) full-time	6 (2.2%)
Relative/friend helping part-time and paid help part-time	6 (2.2%)
Shift Change	
Wives	
Not changing shift	189 (69.0%)
Informally changing shift (working late or early hours)	75 (27.4%)
Formally changing a shift	10 (3.6%)
Husbands	
Not changing shift	197 (71.9%)
Informally changing shift (working late or early hours)	59 (21.5%)
Formally changing a shift	18 (6.6%)
Amount Hours Change ^a	
Wives	
Not adjusting hours	186 (67.9%)
Reducing hours	83 (30.3%)
Increasing hours	5 (1.8%)
Husbands	
Not adjusting hours	190 (69.3%)
Reducing hours	70 (25.5%)
Increasing hours	14 (5.1%)
Division of Childcare Labor During Normal Work Hours	
Wives	
Doing all childcare during work hours	57 (20.8%)
Having mini-shifts throughout day while both are remote	41 (15.0%)
Both remote alternating watching child with spouse based on meetings	37 (13.5%)
Alternating working days with spouse	28 (10.2%)
Doing most of the childcare except occasional relief	22 (8.0%)
Full outsourcing	21 (7.7%)
Staggering shiftwork	13 (4.7%)
Doing all childcare when it is not outsourced	12 (4.4%)
Doing none of the childcare	9 (3.3%)
Only providing occasional childcare relief	5 (1.8%)
Doing none of the childcare when it is not outsourced	3 (1.1%)
Could not decipher from response	26 (9.5%)
Husbands	
Doing none of the childcare	57 (20.8%)
Having mini-shifts throughout day while both are remote	41 (15.0%)
Both remote alternating watching child with spouse based on meetings	37 (13.5%)
Alternating working days with spouse	28 (10.2%)
Only providing occasional childcare relief	22 (8.0%)
Full outsourcing	21 (7.7%)
Staggering shiftwork	13 (4.7%)
Doing none of the childcare when it is not outsourced	12 (4.4%)
Doing all childcare during work hours	9 (3.3%)
Doing most of the childcare except occasional relief	5 (1.8%)
Doing all childcare when it is not outsourced	3 (1.1%)
Could not decipher from response	26 (9.5%)

^a We only coded a change in work hours if the person explicitly mentioned this. We did not assume it otherwise.

Table 3
LCA Fit Statistics

Number of classes	LL	FP	AIC	C-AIC	BIC	SSA-BIC	LMR (<i>p</i>)	BLRT (<i>p</i>)	Entropy
1 class	−2581.52	38	5239.04	5277.04	5376.34	5255.85	N/A	N/A	N/A
2 classes	−2228.75	77	4611.51	4688.51	4889.72	4645.57	<.001	<.001	.945
3 classes	−2043.27	116	4318.55	4434.55	4737.67	4369.86	.77	<.001	.941
4 classes	−1923.75	155	4157.51	4312.51	4717.54	4226.07	.77	<.001	.949
5 classes	−1842.12	194	4072.25	4266.25	4773.20	4158.07	.84	<.001	.953
6 classes	−1781.41	233	4028.81	4261.81	4870.67	4131.88	.77	<.001	.943
7 classes	−1713.82	272	3971.64	4243.64	4954.41	4091.96	.77	<.001	.951
8 classes	−1667.20	311	3956.41	4267.41	5080.09	4093.98	.82	<.001	.956
9 classes	−1628.43	350	3956.86	4306.86	5221.46	4111.68	.76	<.001	.963
10 classes	−1591.14	389	3960.28	4349.28	5365.79	4132.36	.86	<.001	.968

Note. *N* = 274. LCA = latent class analysis; LL = log-likelihood; FP = free parameters; AIC = Akaike information criterion; C-AIC = consistent Akaike information criterion (calculated as the number of free parameters plus the BIC value); BIC = Bayesian information criterion; SSA-BIC = sample-size-adjusted BIC; LMR = Lo, Mendell, and Rubin (2001) adjusted LRT test; BLRT = bootstrapped log-likelihood ratio test.

felt this restriction was important for clarity in data interpretation.⁴ The final *n* for the outcome analyses was 133. Descriptive statistics and correlations for all study variables are presented in Table 5.

Before running the LCA analyses, we examined potential control variables (number of children, household income, age, and spousal age difference) due to their implications for how couples divide labor as well as well-being outcomes. Classes were only significantly different for income (mean income of each class is listed in Table 4). We thus controlled for income in all analyses by regressing the dependent variable of interest on income and using the residuals in the LCA analysis (Bennett et al., 2016). However, for interpretation purposes we reported the means of the original variables (not residuals). Chi-square tests for overall significant differences across classes and significance values are from analyses using residuals. Results are shown in Table 6.

There were significant differences in all outcomes except husbands' sleep hours and husbands' general job performance. For relationship outcomes, both husbands and wives in the *Wife Remote Doing Most* group tended to fare among the best, whereas both husbands and wives in the *Wife Remote and Does It All* group fared the worst. *Remote Minishifts* couples also had high relationship tension scores comparatively. For health outcomes, the *Alternating Days* group generally fared the best, with the highest sleep for both husbands and wives as well as the lowest or second lowest psychological distress. Finally, for job performance, trends tended to diverge by gender and type of performance. We elaborate more on these differences in the Discussion.

Discussion

In this study, we sought to examine if the strategies dual-earner couples are using to meet their competing work and childcare demands during COVID-19 reflect progress toward a more egalitarian division of labor or remain highly gendered, and the link between strategy choice and a range of outcomes. Even though the separation of the spheres of work and home had largely disintegrated, and men were much more likely to be physically present in their homes, we found evidence a substantial portion of couples were engaging in highly gendered strategies. This most commonly involved wives working remotely and taking on all childcare with little adjustment to husbands' work roles, as well as similar scenarios wherein husbands pitched in with

childcare occasionally (e.g., one day a week or during an important meeting for the wife). Even when some outsourcing was available, the remainder of childcare mostly fell on wives. This evidence confirms anecdotal reports of the persistent gendered division of labor during COVID-19.

Further concerning is that for many of the outcomes, women in the most lopsided and common category (*Wife Remote and Does It All*) experienced the least favorable outcomes of all classes, including lowest family cohesion, highest relationship tension, and lowest job performance by both metrics. This is somewhat a departure from research described previously, where results were not consistently poorer for those doing all the labor. It may be due in part to the fact that doing *all* of the childcare equates to many more childcare hours overall than when childcare was outsourced during work hours. Men in these couples were not immune to negative outcomes, as they also experienced the lowest family cohesion and highest relationship tension. Although their work situations seemed minimally altered, job performance was rather low compared to many of the other classes as well. Perhaps these men are less focused at work due to marital strife resulting from the increased WF burdens falling on their wives.

There are several practical implications of these findings. With regards to the counterintuitive performance findings, it is important for companies to understand that withholding flexibility from parents affects the entire couple—not just the member who picks up the slack. From a societal standpoint, these results raise serious concerns about potential setbacks in women's career advancement. Moreover, for couples who find themselves in a situation where the wife can work remote and the husband cannot, our findings suggest that they will fare considerably better if the husband actively provides some relief by taking an occasional day off or cutting hours short to support his remote partner. In fact, both husbands and wives in the *Wife Remote and Doing Most* class had significantly better relationship outcomes and relative job performance compared to those in the *Wife Remote and Does It All* class.

In addition to gendered strategies, multiple unique egalitarian strategies emerged. We focus most of our discussion on these

⁴ Classes did not differ significantly on the extent to which they followed plans. $\chi^2(6) = 7.14, p = .31$.

Table 4
Descriptions of LCA Classes

Class label	Remote Work		Shift Change		Amount Hours Change		Division of labor Specifics	
	Wife	Husband	Outside Help	Wife	Husband	Wife	Wife	Husband
Wife remote and does it all 22.2% \$109,518	Working remote (.89)	Not working remote (.93)	No help (.81)	No change (.79)	No change (.96)	No change (.71) or Reducing hours (.27)	Doing all (1.0)	Doing none (1.0)
"I am working remotely from home and also caring for my 6-month [old] twins and homeschooling my 9-year-old daughter. My husband works outside of the home." "I must continue to go into work as it's deemed an essential business, so my spouse is currently conducting meetings with our son playing in the background and doing what work she can late at night or early in the morning when he is asleep."								
Egalitarian remote workers with planned mini-shifts 16.6% \$180,1331	Working remote (.95)	Working remote (.93)	No help (.85)	Informally changing shift (.57) or no change (.41)	Informally changing shift (.52) or no change (.48)	No change (.66) or reducing hours (.35)	Taking mini-shifts throughout the day while remote (1.0)	Taking mini-shifts throughout the day while remote (1.0)
"We are planning to take 2-3 hour shifts as needed, triage and complete only essential projects as needed, and work after our children go to bed or on the weekends if necessary." "We will get some help from my parents (maybe 1-2 days/week). We will do split shifts on the other days (4 hours each) and probably take a lot of emergency/sick/vacation time and/or unpaid leave."								
Egalitarian remote workers with daily need-based alternation without reducing work hours 14.4% \$155,984	Working remote (.95)	Working remote (.95)	No help (.95)	Informally changing shift (.58) or no change (.42)	Informally changing shift (.52) or no change (.48)	No change (.95)	Alternating who does childcare based on meetings, deadlines, or child-needs (1.0)	Alternating who does childcare based on meetings, deadlines, or child-needs (1.0)
"We take turns working in the home office while the other entertains the kids. We both work reduced hours during the day and finish our work at night." "We set a schedule each morning and then we rotate work and being with our children. Whenever I can take the infant while also working (e.g., conference calls), I do that. My partner gets up early to complete work and I typically stay up late."								
Alternating working days while not remote and reducing hours 13.5% \$131,966	Not working remote (.43)	Not working remote (.54)	No help (.54)	No change (.84)	No change (.80)	Reducing hours (.71)	Alternating working days with spouse (1.0)	Alternating working days with spouse (1.0)
"We are alternating work days. My wife works Monday/Wednesday, I work Tuesday/Thursday. We split Friday. We are both cutting back on our hours."								
Husband not remote and outsourcing fully or partially outsourcing with wife filling in gap 13.3% \$132,597	Not working remote (.52) or Working remote (.39)	Not working remote (.84)	Relative/friend helping full-time (.38) or Relative/friend helping part-time (.36)	No change (.89)	No change (1.0)	No change (.74)	Fully outsourcing (.64) or doing all none of the childcare of the portion not outsourced (.36)	Fully outsourcing (.64) or doing all none of the childcare of the portion not outsourced (.36)
"We have my mother watching our twins in Louisiana during the work week & we drive from Texas to Louisiana on the weekends to visit."								
"We will see if my parents can provide additional assistance and [the wife] will try to work and watch the kids."								

(table continues)

Table 4 (continued)

Class label	Remote Work		Shift Change		Amount Hours Change		Division of labor Specifics	
	Wife	Husband	Wife	Husband	Wife	Husband	Wife	Husband
Wife not remote and staggering shiftwork or husband does childcare 10.4% \$130,556	Not working remote (.76)	Working remote (.54) or Not working remote (.46)	No change (.72)	No change (.75)	No change (.65) or Reducing hours (.28)	No change (.79)	Staggering shiftwork (.59) or doing none of the childcare (.41)	Staggering shiftwork (.59) or doing all of the childcare (.41)
"We are trying to have alternating schedules. [The husband] will work during the night while she watches our son and she will work during the day while [the husband] watches our son." "We don't have childcare and [the wife] still [has] to go to work so my husband is managing his job remotely while taking care of our daughter."								
Wife remote and husband pitches in on occasion 9.6% \$157,069	Working remote (1.0)	Not working remote (.29) or working remote (.45)	No help (.88)	No change (.81)	No change (.72) or reducing hours (.28)	No change (.76)	Doing most of the childcare except occasional relief (1.0)	Providing only occasional childcare relief (1.0)
"I will primarily work from home remotely while homeschooling and entertaining my children. [My husband] will occasionally work from home on days I have meetings that are extremely important so he can take care of our children."								

Note. LCA = latent class analysis. Values in parentheses are odds ratios associated with being in that class and having the listed code. Any code that had a .25 or higher odds ratio for a given class was reported. \$ indicates mean household income in USD for that class.

strategies given their novelty and additional nuance than those mentioned in previous typologies. Two of these (*Remote Minishifts*, *Remote Need-Based Alternating*) occurred when both members of the couple were working remotely. This lends support to the idea that the removal of separate spheres and physical embeddedness of men in family spaces may facilitate equality. Moreover, although these two strategies appear similar on the surface, they differ in regard to the specific manner in which couples were trading off watching children. In one class, partners scheduled minishifts (e.g., one person works mornings and the other works afternoons). With this process came a natural reduction in work hours for both partners for many members of this class. In the other class, scheduling was not as rigid and varied based on children's needs and partners' immediate work obligations and work hours were not reduced. These distinct strategies resulted in some outcome differences, most notably job performance. Husbands in the *Remote Minishifts* class reported significantly lower relative job performance than the *Remote Need-Based Alternating* and these couples had the lowest couple-level relative job performance of all classes. Wives' performance was relatively low as well, though not significantly different than the *Remote Need-Based Alternating* class, and within the *Remote Minishifts* husbands' performance suffered more than their wives.

The third unique egalitarian strategy (*Alternating Days*) tended to occur when neither the wife nor husband were working remotely and were in jobs where they could each work different days, which resulted in an overall reduction of hours for both people. Comparing this strategy to the two other egalitarian strategies, this group seemed to fare the best. They had favorable means on all outcomes and wives performed significantly better than the *Remote Minishifts* and had lower psychological distress than both remote egalitarian groups. Couple-level summed performance and psychological distress were also more favorable. Finally, the *Outsourcing Fully* strategy was also egalitarian in the sense that neither member of the couple was primarily responsible for childcare, allowing both to maintain adequate levels of performance. This study provides empirical support for implementation of the *Outsourcing Fully* WF management strategy, which heretofore has been primarily conceptual (Masterson & Hoobler, 2015).

From a practical standpoint, our findings suggest that although it varies somewhat by specific outcome, *Alternating Days* may be the best strategy for couples, especially those who are not working remotely. It preserves well-being while maintaining adequate levels of performance. Speculatively, by virtue of alternating, both people in these couples were essentially able to keep work and family segmented, which has been linked to better health and performance outcomes (e.g., Kinnunen et al., 2016; Smit et al., 2016). From a theoretical sense, this suggests that it may not so much be the separation of gender spheres but rather the separation of work and family life that helps couples thrive. It is important to note that this strategy may not be an option for all job types or for all couples if it results in income loss, although it does suggest that organizations might reconsider requiring workers to report every day during the pandemic. They may perform just as well while being less distressed under this arrangement versus one where they try to work every day. Public policy could help achieve

Table 5
Means, Standard Deviations, and Correlations

Variable	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22
1. Husband's age	—																					
2. Wife's age	.75**	—																				
3. Total income	.01	.10	—																			
4. Child under 6	-.06	-.01	.04	—																		
5. Child under 18	.14	.13	-.01	.46**	—																	
6. Family cohes- w	-.05	-.06	.08	-.04	0.00	(.79)																
7. Family cohes- h	-.04	-.05	-.07	-.15	-.08	.56**	(.73)															
8. Tension- w	.09	.12	.02	.18*	.03	-.64**	-.55**	(.85)														
9. Tension- h	-.06	-.02	-.04	.09	-.01	-.35**	-.50**	.57**	(.83)													
10. Sleep- w	-.17	-.16	.04	-.13	-.18*	.15	.15	-.17*	-.01	-.27**												
11. Sleep- h	-.05	-.06	.09	-.17*	-.14	.06	.20*	-.15	-.27**	.21*	—											
12. Total sleep	-.14	-.14	.08	-.19*	-.20*	.14	.22*	-.21*	-.18*	.79**	.77**	—										
13. Distress- w	-.05	-.16	-.06	.10	.01	-.27**	-.25**	.48**	.25**	-.22*	-.05	-.18*	(.92)									
14. Distress- h	-.04	-.07	-.03	.05	-.02	-.20*	-.26**	.30**	.41**	-.10	-.25**	-.22*	.51**	(.92)								
15. Total distress	-.05	-.13	-.05	.09	-.01	-.27**	-.29**	.45**	.37**	-.18*	-.17	-.23**	.86**	.86**	—							
16. General job perf- w	-.08	-.01	.03	0.00	.02	.40**	.24**	-.44**	-.18*	.08	-.04	.02	-.40**	-.18*	-.34**	(.84)						
17. General job perf- h	.05	0.00	-.12	.07	.14	.24**	.25**	-.22*	-.31**	-.01	.09	.05	-.25**	-.49**	-.42**	.36**	(.86)					
18. Total general job perf	-.02	0.00	-.05	.04	.09	.39**	.29**	-.41**	-.30**	.04	.02	.04	-.40**	-.40**	-.46**	.84**	.81**	—				
19. Relative job perf- w	-.02	-.06	.05	.01	-.03	.31**	.14	-.34**	-.21*	-.01	.04	.02	-.20*	-.16	-.21*	.38**	.34**	.44**	—			
20. Relative job perf- h	.25**	.12	-.09	-.13	-.04	.16	.20*	-.31**	-.32*	-.06	.09	.02	-.30**	-.36**	-.38**	.26**	.51**	.46**	.21*	—		
21. Total relative job perf	.15	.03	-.02	-.08	-.04	.30**	.22*	-.42**	-.34**	-.05	.08	.02	-.32**	-.34**	-.38**	.41**	.54**	.58**	.78**	.77**	—	
22. Followed plan- w	.05	.07	-.06	-.15*	-.05	.16	.25**	-.12	-.10	.08	-.07	.01	-.07	-.18*	-.14	.13	.30**	.25**	.11	.30**	.26**	—
<i>M</i>	36.33	34.81	140.70	1.36	1.84	4.07	4.09	2.20	1.77	6.56	6.76	13.32	2.11	1.83	3.93	3.77	3.98	7.76	77.33	81.47	158.79	7.48
<i>SD</i>	6.63	5.78	72.15	.56	.82	.73	.68	.96	.81	1.17	1.13	1.79	.82	.75	1.36	.72	.67	1.14	19.93	19.73	30.82	2.44

Note. Reliability information is located on the diagonal. Child under 6 = the number of children in the household under the age of 6; Child under 18 = the number of children in the household under the age of 18. A variable followed by a "w" refers to the wife's report of said variable. A variable followed by a "h" refers to the husband's report of said variable. Family cohes = family cohesion; Tension = relationship tension; Sleep = sleep quantity in hours; Total sleep = sleep quantity in hours summed across the couple; Emotional exhaust = emotional exhaustion; Total emotional exhaust = emotional exhaustion summed across the couple; Distress = psychological distress; Total distress = psychological distress summed across the couple; General job perf = general job performance; Total general job perf = general job performance summed across the couple; Relative job perf = relative job performance summed across the couple; Followed plan = how well the plan was followed.

* $p < .05$. ** $p < .01$.

Table 6*LCA Results Linking Class Membership to Outcomes, Controlling for Income*

Outcome	Wife remote and does it all (A)	Wife remote and husband pitches in on occasion (B)	Husband not remote and outsourcing fully or partially outsourcing with wife filling in gaps (C)	Alternating working days while not remote & reducing hours (D)	Wife not remote and staggering shiftwork or husband does childcare (E)	Egalitarian remote workers with planned mini-shifts (F)	Egalitarian remote workers with daily need-based alternation without reducing hours (G)	Overall Chi-Square
Family Cohesion								
Wife	3.68 ^{BDFG}	4.46 ^{AE}	4.02	4.38 ^A	3.95 ^B	4.24 ^A	4.20 ^A	18.48**
Husband	3.71 ^{BDEFG}	4.51 ^{ACEF}	4.00 ^{BD}	4.40 ^{AC}	4.07 ^{AB}	4.07 ^{AB}	4.30 ^A	26.26**
Relationship Tension								
Wife	2.61 ^{BCDEG}	1.78 ^{AF}	1.82 ^{AF}	2.05 ^A	2.05 ^A	2.57 ^{BC}	2.06 ^A	16.02*
Husband	2.08 ^{BC}	1.29 ^{ADEFG}	1.40 ^{AF}	1.73 ^B	1.72 ^B	2.06 ^{BC}	1.73 ^B	23.77**
Sleep Hours								
Wife	6.31 ^D	6.04 ^{DF}	6.40 ^D	7.22 ^{ABCE}	6.27 ^D	6.99 ^B	6.72	15.01*
Husband	6.50 ^D	6.71	6.54 ^D	7.32 ^{AC}	6.89	6.88	6.74	6.46
Total	12.82 ^D	12.73 ^D	12.98 ^D	14.47 ^{ABCE}	13.15 ^D	13.86	13.44	12.79*
Psychological Distress								
Wife	2.27 ^D	1.80 ^{EF}	2.04 ^D	1.54 ^{ACEFG}	2.46 ^{BD}	2.33 ^{BD}	1.98 ^D	25.11**
Husband	1.75 ^{BE}	1.40 ^{ADEFG}	1.77	1.58 ^E	2.25 ^{ABD}	1.92 ^B	1.92 ^B	17.19**
Total	4.03 ^{BD}	3.20 ^{AEF}	3.83 ^D	3.08 ^{ACEFG}	4.70 ^{BD}	4.27 ^{BD}	3.89 ^D	23.39**
General Job Performance								
Wife	3.47 ^{CDE}	3.76 ^D	3.94 ^A	4.23 ^{ABFG}	3.97 ^A	3.59 ^D	3.73 ^D	18.45**
Husband	4.06	4.25 ^F	4.12	4.01	3.92	3.73 ^B	3.87	5.81
Total	7.52 ^D	7.91	8.05	8.27 ^{AF}	7.93	7.32 ^D	7.61	10.41
Relative Job Performance								
Wife	69.34 ^{BE}	85.77 ^{AF}	78.43	79.83	83.69 ^{AF}	72.42 ^{BE}	79.76	12.23
Husband	80.35 ^{BC}	94.49 ^{ADEFG}	89.24 ^{AF}	80.82 ^B	83.01 ^{BF}	65.78 ^{BCEG}	82.39 ^{BF}	33.48**
Total	149.55 ^{BCE}	180.06 ^{ADFG}	167.76 ^{AF}	160.43 ^{BF}	167.12 ^{AF}	137.92 ^{BCDEG}	162.37 ^{BF}	27.74**

Note. LCA = latent class analysis. The mean values of outcomes for different classes are reported. Superscripts indicate profiles that are significantly different from each other at least at $p < .05$. For example, for husbands, the *Alternating Working Days While Not Remote and Reducing Hours* group is significantly different in sleep hours than the *Wife Remote and Does it All* and the *Husband Not Remote and Outsourcing Fully or Partially Outsourcing with Wife Filling in Gaps* groups, but the *Wife Remote and Husband Pitches in on Occasion*, *Wife Not Remote and Staggering Shiftwork or Husband Does Childcare*, *Egalitarian Remote Workers With Planned Mini-shifts*, and the *Egalitarian Remote Workers with Daily Need-Based Alternation Without Reducing Hours* groups are not significantly different from one another. Mean differences between classes should only be interpreted when the overall chi-square statistic is significant.

* $p < .05$. ** $p < .01$.

this as well by supplementing incomes or providing flexibility mandates.

Also intertwined in strategy choice is the location of work. Many workers were required to work remotely due to state mandated closures, and in that case, were less likely to adopt the *Alternating Days* strategy. Given projections that location flexibility is here to stay (Ozimek, 2020) many couples may find themselves both working remotely in the future. In this case when both people are working remotely, our results suggest that couples would be advised to adopt a more flexible approach (e.g., *Remote Need-Based Alternating*) rather than rigid minishift schedule. It is unclear which mechanisms are driving the differences. Speculatively, it may be enhanced communication that this strategy requires, the fact that couples are more responsive to each other's needs and that reduces marital tension (indeed there was a trend for lower marital tension in the *Remote Need-Based Alternating* class), or having a shared meaning of the situation—a key component the Double ABCX theory (e.g., Weber, 2011). Future research would ben-

efit from testing these mechanisms to derive even more specific recommendations.

Our results must be interpreted in light of a few limitations. First, our sample had a high average income, drawing into question its broader generalizability to lower income workers. We also used self-report measures of job performance, which can be prone to inflation (DeNisi & Murphy, 2017). Third, we were focused on the very narrow context of COVID-19. However, we believe our results still have important implications for couples in other situations that share some features of the pandemic, including extreme weather where schools and daycares may close but workplaces still require remote work, situations where children have a disability or chronic illness and cannot attend typical childcare arrangements, or even parents facing long daycare waitlists (e.g., Shellenbarger, 2010) and must manage work with an infant at home.

In closing, our research presents a rare glimpse into how dual-earner couples manage childcare during a crisis situation when the typical fallbacks are not available. The results suggest that, even in

the context of an unprecedented crisis when the spheres of work and home were overlapping for men and women, gendered patterns of childcare responsibilities persist. It has been argued that the conditions of the pandemic offered an opportunity for fathers to engage more fully with their family roles and to shift the balance in gender role expectations. Instead, the data presented here suggest that the burden of intensive, unexpected, and ongoing childcare responsibilities is disproportionately falling on mothers. Yet when parents did create more novel and egalitarian strategies for managing childcare in the crisis, particularly by alternating work days, their performance and well-being were preserved. Such novel solutions may be precisely those that help families and organizations move forward in a post-COVID reality.

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Appendix

List of Items Completed by Both Spouses

Demographics

- What is your gender?
- What is your age?
- What is your race/ethnicity? Please check all that apply. [Hispanic or Latino or Spanish Origin of any race, American Indian or Alaskan Native, Asian, Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander, Black or African American, White, Other (please describe), Prefer not to disclose]
- How many children do you have under 18 that primarily reside in your home?
- How many children do you have under 6 that primarily reside in your home?
- What is your annual income?

Plan for Managing Childcare and Work Commitments

The following set of questions ask about you and your spouse's plan for managing work and family responsibilities during the COVID-19 outbreak

- What is you and your spouse's plan for dealing with both of your work commitments during the upcoming period when your normal childcare is disrupted? Please be as detailed as possible.

- How will you have to adjust your work role during this time?
- How will your spouse have to adjust his/her work role during this time?

Implementation of Plan

We previously asked you about you and your spouse's plan for dealing with both of your work commitments during the pandemic when your normal childcare was disrupted. You stated your plan was [insert text with participant's response at Time 1].

- We'd like you to rate how well you followed that plan. That is, on a scale of 1 to 10 where 1 is "did not follow the plan at all" and 10 is followed "the plan perfectly", where do you fall?

Family Cohesion

Indicate to what extent you agree with the following statements. In thinking about your family during this time . . .

- Family members really helped and supported one another
- There is a feeling of togetherness in our family
- We really got along well with each other

(Appendix continues)

Relationship Tension

During this period . . .

- I have felt irritated or resentful about things my partner did or didn't do
- I have felt tense from fighting, arguing, or disagreeing with my partner
- I have felt my partner doesn't understand me

Sleep Quantity

During this time period, on average, how many hours of actual sleep did you get at night?

Psychological Distress

During this time period, how often have you felt . . .

- tired out for no reason?
- nervous?
- so nervous that nothing could calm you down?
- hopeless?
- restless or fidgety?
- so restless that you could not sit still?
- depressed?
- that everything was an effort?
- that nothing could cheer you up?
- worthless?

Job Performance

Please rate how you have felt about your job performance during this period. How well have you . . .

. . . handled the responsibilities and daily demands of your work?

. . . made the right decisions?

. . . performed without mistakes?

. . . gotten things done on time?

During this time, many parents may not be able to meet 100% of their work responsibilities. Assuming prior to this period you were able to fully meet your work responsibilities (i.e., 100%), what percent do you feel you will be able to meet during this time?

Attention Checks

- I am using the internet right now
- I was born on February 30
- I have never brushed my teeth
- I do not understand a word of English
- I frequently have picnics with my friends on the planet Jupiter

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